

Employment Rights in Punjab

A practical starting point

This guide helps workers in Punjab organize the facts before seeking qualified advice. Employment rights depend on the type and size of the establishment, the worker's role, the contract, and the law that applies. Rules and wage notifications can change.

- Keep your appointment letter, contract, CNIC copy, pay slips, attendance records, leave approvals, and workplace messages.
- Write down dates, names, and events while they are fresh.
- Do not sign a resignation, settlement, or blank paper that you do not understand.

Important limitation

This publication is educational information, not legal advice or representation. It does not decide whether a person is legally classified as a worker, employee, contractor, or manager.

Your employment record

Terms should be clear

The official Industrial and Commercial Employment (Standing Orders) Ordinance, 1968 includes written terms and conditions of service among its standing orders for covered establishments. Coverage and provincial amendments should be checked for the workplace concerned.

- Confirm employer name, job title, start date, probation, wage, pay date, hours, place of work, leave, benefits, notice, and confidentiality terms.
- Ask for a signed copy of every document you sign.
- Compare bank credits and pay slips with the agreed wage and deductions.
- Keep evidence of overtime instructions and work performed outside normal hours.

If no written contract exists

Collect appointment messages, identity cards, attendance, bank records, rosters, work emails, and statements from people with first-hand knowledge. These may help show the working relationship, but their legal effect depends on the facts.

Pay, hours, leave, and safety

Check the rule that actually applies

Punjab has separate laws and notifications for different workplaces and subjects, including minimum wages, shops and establishments, factories, social security, and standing orders. Do not assume one rule covers every worker.

- Check the current minimum-wage notification for the relevant category and effective date.
- Compare recorded hours, rest intervals, weekly holidays, and overtime with the applicable law and contract.
- Keep leave requests and replies in writing.
- Report an unsafe condition through a traceable channel and preserve supporting material without putting yourself at risk.
- Review unexplained deductions promptly and request a written calculation.

Punjab's public helpline directory currently lists Labour and HR Department helpline 1314. Verify availability before relying on it.

Termination and disputes

Before taking action

The standing orders framework addresses termination, retrenchment, punishment, service certificates, and related procedures for covered establishments. The correct forum and remedy depend on classification, workplace, limitation periods, and the relief requested.

- Ask for the reason and effective date in writing.
- Preserve the termination letter, show-cause notice, inquiry papers, response, final-pay calculation, and service certificate.
- Make a timeline from recruitment through the final event.
- List unpaid wages, benefits, leave, or property separately and show how each figure was calculated.
- Avoid altering screenshots or forwarding confidential material without advice.

Urgent advice may be needed when a response or filing deadline is running. A complaint to an employer, labour authority, court, or other forum should be based on the applicable law and evidence.

Action checklist and official sources

Prepare this file

- One-page chronology with dates and people involved.
- Contract and all later amendments.
- Last twelve months of pay and attendance evidence, where available.
- Relevant notices, replies, policies, and witness details.
- A short statement of the outcome you want.

Official sources checked July 2026

- Pakistan Code, Industrial and Commercial Employment (Standing Orders) Ordinance, 1968:
<https://pakistancode.gov.pk/english/UY2FqaJw1-apaUY2Fqa-apaUY2Npa5tmaQ%253D%253D-sg-xxxxxxxxxxxx>
- Punjab Law Portal information: https://www.pitb.gov.pk/law_portal
- Punjab government helplines: <https://punjab.gov.pk/helplines>

Always check the latest Gazette notification and the law applicable to the particular establishment. Official web copies may themselves be under review.